

ADA / WCAG 2.1 Accessibility Audit

Page 1 — City of Colorado Springs, 2C Road Improvements

URL: <https://coloradosprings.gov/2C>

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA • **Legal frame:** ADA Title II

Audit Date: May 13, 2026

Auditor: Emma Moore, independent self-assessment

Summary

Twelve distinct accessibility findings were identified on the 2C Road Improvements page, ranging from **Critical** (assistive technology blockers) to **Low / Advisory** (best-practice improvements). The page reflects several accessibility best practices, including a working skip link, a main landmark, declared page language, and correctly labeled form inputs. The findings below identify the gaps that prevent full WCAG 2.1 Level AA conformance.

Severity	Count
Critical	2
High	3
Medium	4
Low / Advisory	3
Total	12

Findings

CRITICAL

1. Untitled Iframe (ArcGIS Paving Map)

Element: `<iframe src="experience.arcgis.com/experience/db395f7b...">`

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: The embedded ArcGIS paving map iframe has no title attribute. Screen readers cannot identify the purpose of this embedded content. The 2C_Animation iframe has a title, but this second iframe — which contains the primary interactive map — does not.

Fix: Add title="2C Paving Map – Interactive" to the iframe element.

2. H1 Appears After H2 in DOM Order

Element: Search modal `<h2>` precedes the page `<h1>`

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: The Search modal heading is marked as <h2> and appears before the page's <h1> ("2C Road Improvements") in the DOM. While visually the search is a modal overlay, its heading level in source order creates a broken document outline for assistive technologies that read sequentially.

Fix: Change the search modal heading to an <h1> within the modal's own context (or use aria-labelledby on the dialog), and ensure the page's primary <h1> is the first heading in source order.

HIGH

3. Duplicate Heading Text on All FAQ Accordions

Element: 22 duplicate <h3> entries in FAQ accordion

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A), 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)

Impact: Every accordion FAQ item renders its heading text twice in the DOM — once as the button trigger inside an <h3>, and once as a static <h3> for the expanded content. This creates 22 duplicate heading entries in the page outline. Screen reader users navigating by headings encounter every FAQ topic twice with no way to distinguish trigger from content.

Fix: Remove the static expanded-content heading (ARIA regions are sufficient), give it a visually-hidden distinguishing label, or mark it aria-hidden="true" since the button heading already announces the topic.

4. All-Caps Heading Text

Element: 23 uppercase <h3> instances

WCAG: 1.4.8 Visual Presentation (Level AAA, advisory at AA)

Impact: All FAQ headings use ALL-CAPS text directly in the HTML (e.g., "HOW DOES THE CITY DETERMINE WHICH STREETS WILL RECEIVE IMPROVEMENTS AND WHEN?"). All-caps text is harder to read for users with dyslexia or cognitive disabilities, and some screen readers read each letter individually.

Fix: Use standard mixed-case text in HTML and apply CSS text-transform: uppercase if the visual all-caps style is required. This separates visual style from the underlying accessible text.

5. Heading Level Skips in Statistics Section

Element: H2 → H3 → H4 → H3 → H4 → H2 sequence

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: Heading hierarchy skips from H2 ("Quick Stats and Paving Lists") to H3 ("Accomplishments through March 31, 2026") to H4 ("2026 Year-to-Date 2C Statistics"), then back to H3 ("Paving Lists"), H4 ("Cumulative 2C Statistics"), and H2 again. Inconsistent H4 usage creates a disorganized document outline.

Fix: Audit heading structure for a consistent hierarchy without skipped levels. "Accomplishments" should likely be H3, with "Year-to-Date" and "Cumulative" as consistent H4 subsections.

MEDIUM

6. Hero Banner Image Has No Alt Text

Element: Generic element labeled "2C_Animation"

WCAG: 1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A)

Impact: The decorative car-on-road illustration in the "About 2C" section is rendered via a referenced element with no descriptive alt. The accessibility tree shows it as a generic container rather than a properly labeled image.

Fix: If purely decorative, use alt="" and role="presentation". If informational, provide a brief description.

7. No ARIA role="search" on Search Form

Element: Site search <form> element

WCAG: 4.1.2 Name, Role, Value (Level A)

Impact: The site search form lacks a role="search" landmark. Screen reader users navigating by landmarks cannot quickly jump to the search functionality.

Fix: Add role="search" to the <form> element containing the search input.

8. Decorative SVG Icons Not Hidden from Assistive Technology

Element: Vertical sidebar navigation SVG icons

WCAG: 1.1.1 Non-text Content (Level A) — advisory

Impact: The vertical sidebar navigation items (GoCOS Contact, City Code/Charter, Accessibility, Language Access) use SVG icons alongside link text. SVGs lack aria-hidden="true", which may produce redundant announcements in some screen reader configurations.

Fix: Add aria-hidden="true" to each decorative SVG icon in the navigation.

9. Language Selector Has No Visible Label

Element: Google Translate dropdown

WCAG: 1.3.1 Info and Relationships (Level A)

Impact: The Google Translate dropdown has aria-label="Select Language" but no visible <label> element. Users relying on voice navigation (Dragon NaturallySpeaking, etc.) may struggle to activate it by voice.

Fix: Add a visible "Select Language" label or use a <label> element alongside the aria-label.

LOW / ADVISORY

10. Ambiguous H4 Subheading Text in ConeZone Section

Element: "Interactive Tools Online Help Drivers Navigate Construction"

WCAG: 2.4.6 Headings and Labels (Level AA)

Impact: The H4 heading text reads awkwardly and could confuse screen reader users. "Help" appears to be a verb but is ambiguous in context.

Fix: Revise to a clearer subheading such as "Interactive Tools to Help Drivers Navigate Construction."

11. PDF Links Lack File Type/Size Indication

Element: 11 paving list links (2016–2026)

WCAG: 2.4.4 Link Purpose (Level A)

Impact: Paving list links are labeled with raw filenames (2024_2c_paving_list.pdf, etc.) without indication of file type or size. WCAG advisory guidance and best practice recommend this for document links.

Fix: Append a visible "(PDF)" indicator to each link label: e.g., "2026 Paving List (PDF)".

12. Phone tel: href Contains Non-Numeric Characters

Element: `tel:%28719%29385-ROAD%287623%29`

WCAG: 2.4.4 Link Purpose (Level A) — advisory

Impact: The phone link's href contains the URL-encoded letters "ROAD". RFC 3966 specifies that tel: URIs should only contain digits and the "+" character. Some assistive technologies and VoIP apps may fail to parse it.

Fix: Change the href to `tel:+17193857623`.

Quick-Reference Summary Table

#	Issue	WCAG	Severity
1	Untitled iframe (ArcGIS paving map)	4.1.2	Critical
2	H1 appears after H2 in DOM	1.3.1	Critical
3	Duplicate heading text in FAQ accordions	1.3.1, 2.4.6	High
4	All-caps heading text	1.4.8	High
5	Heading level skips in stats section	1.3.1	High
6	Hero illustration lacks alt	1.1.1	Medium
7	Search form missing role="search"	4.1.2	Medium
8	Decorative SVG icons not aria-hidden	1.1.1	Medium
9	Language selector lacks visible label	1.3.1	Medium
10	Ambiguous H4 in ConeZone section	2.4.6	Low
11	PDF links lack file-type indicator	2.4.4	Low
12	Phone tel: contains non-numeric chars	2.4.4	Low

Recommended Priority Order for Remediation

1. Add title attribute to the ArcGIS Paving Map iframe (5-minute fix)
2. Fix the H1/H2 source-order issue in the search modal
3. Resolve duplicate FAQ accordion headings at the CMS template level
4. Fix the heading-level skip in the statistics section
5. Switch all-caps headings to CSS text-transform
6. Add role="search" to the site search form
7. Add aria-hidden to decorative sidebar SVGs
8. Append (PDF) indicators to all paving-list links
9. Correct the phone number tel: href encoding
10. Clarify the ConeZone subheading text

Notes on Methodology

This audit is a self-assessment conducted by the author against the WCAG 2.1 Level AA standard, which is the conformance target referenced in the City of Colorado Springs Web Accessibility statement. Findings were identified through inspection of the published page source and accessibility tree. A formal third-party audit conducted by an IAAP-credentialed auditor (CPACC or WAS) or by an accessibility firm (Deque, Level Access, TPGi, Knowbility, or equivalent) is recommended prior to any binding conformance claim. This document is offered as a constructive starting point for the City's web team and Office of Accessibility.

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